POWER BI CASE STUDY

What makes a Spotify track popular?

Across 7,920 tracks, 2,548 artists, and seven decades of releases.



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Popularity is shaped by artists, format, and timing

Dataset

7,920 Spotify tracks by 2,548 artists, released from 1952 to 2025.

Questions

What matters more, artist popularity or followers?

Comparisons

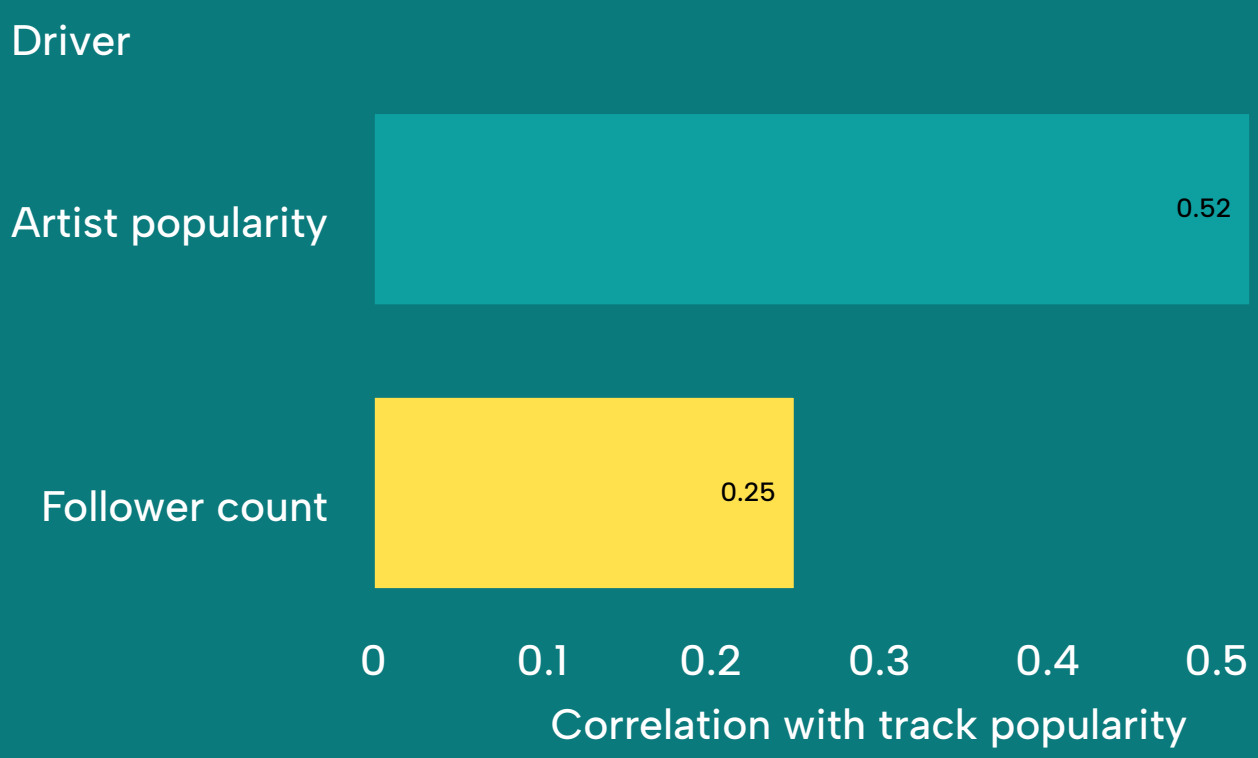
Album types, explicit content, track length, genres, artists, and release volume.

Workflow

Power Query cleaning, Power BI modeling, DAX measures, and interactive dashboarding.

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Artist popularity is the clearest signal



CORRELATION

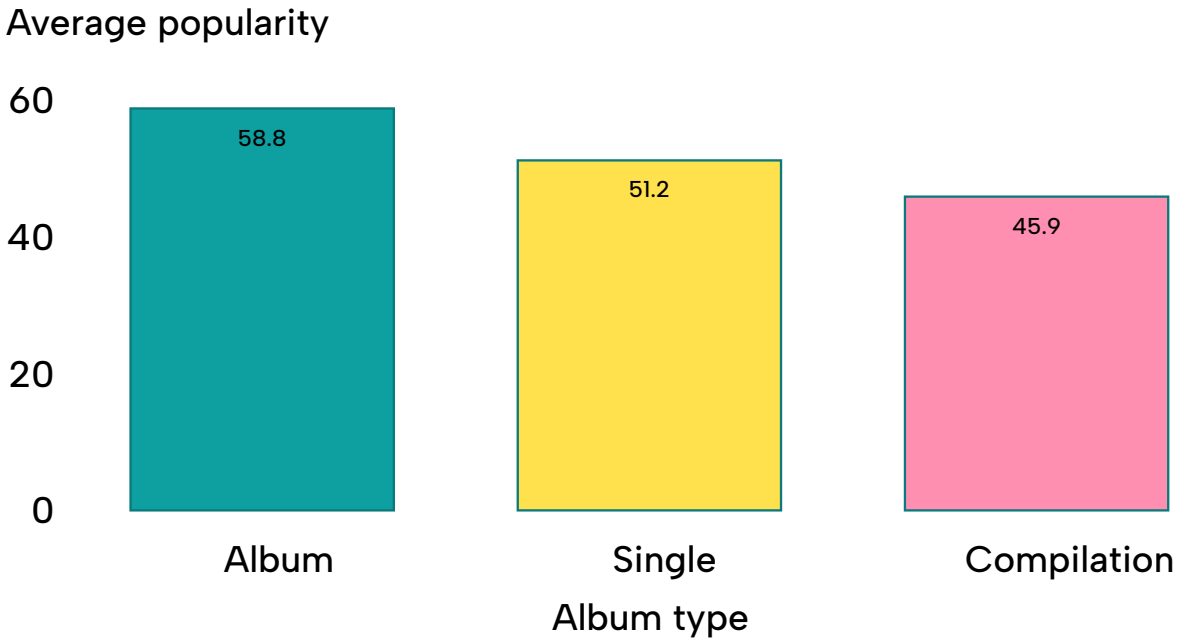
0.52

Artist popularity correlates with track popularity, versus about **0.25** for follower count.

A track benefits more from the artist's established popularity signal than from raw follower scale alone.

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Albums outperform singles and compilations

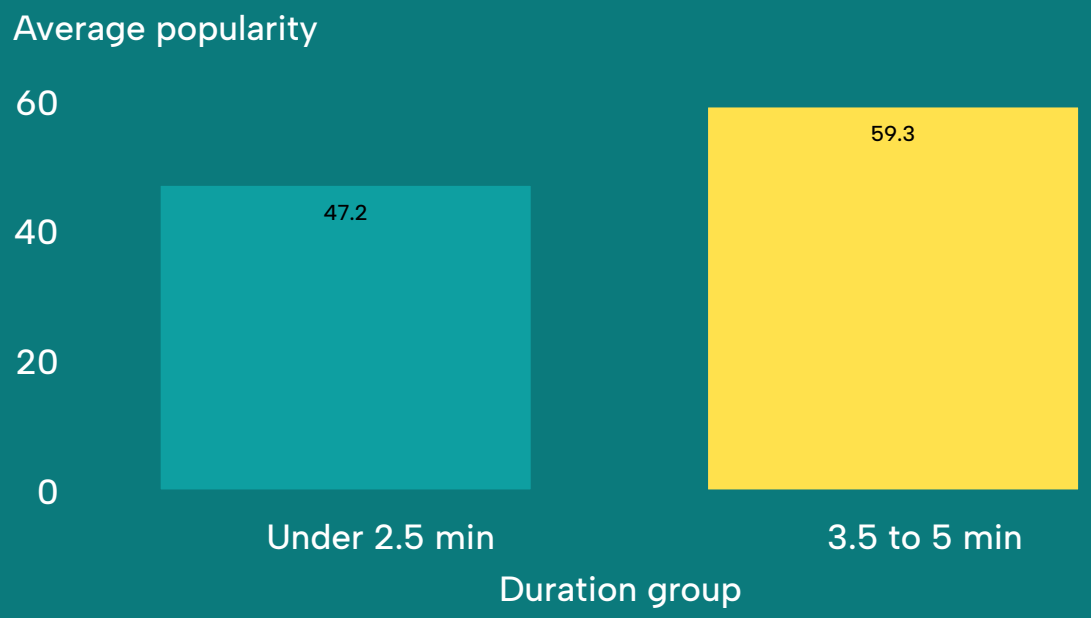


61.1
Explicit tracks

54.6
Clean tracks

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The strongest duration range is 3.5 to 5 minutes



DURATION SIGNAL

59.3

3.5 to 5 minutes leads the comparison.

Tracks under 2.5 minutes average 47.2, the weakest duration group. The pattern suggests a middle range performs better than very short or very long tracks.

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Genre averages cluster near the high-50s to low-60s

Dashboard comparison

- **Asian Pop**
- **Punk/Emo**
- **Hip-Hop/Rap**
- **R&B/Soul**
- **Indie/Alternative**
- **Pop**
- **Latin**
- **Christian/Gospel**
- **Country**
- **Rock**

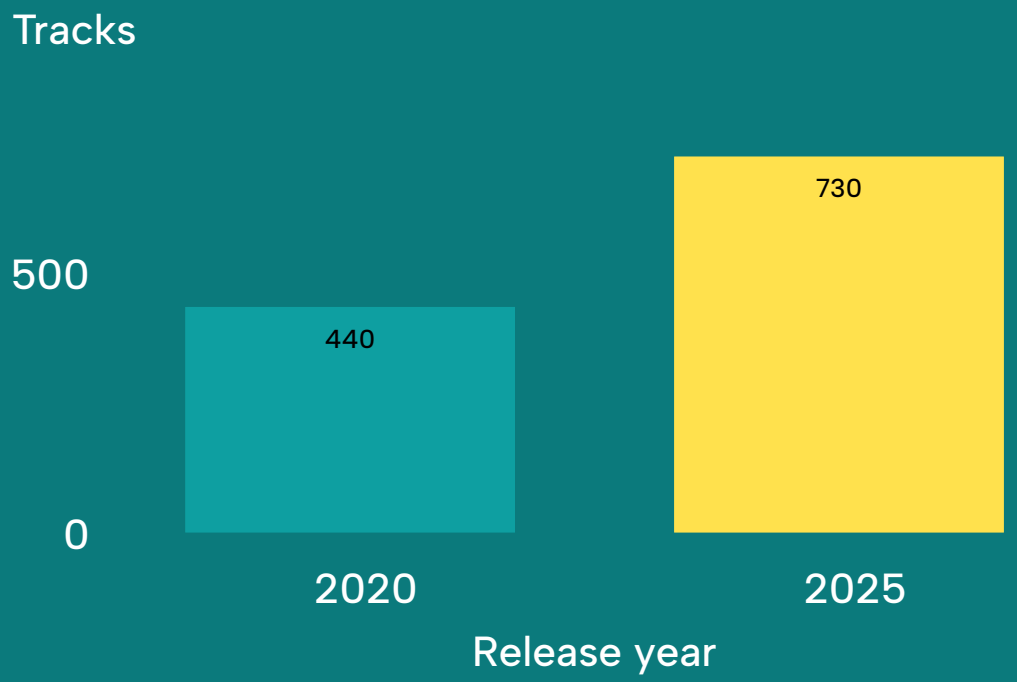
ARTIST-LEVEL LEADERS

HUNTR/X, Saja Boys, Disco Lines, The Goo Goo Dolls, Rumi, and Olivia Dean

Read rankings alongside total track counts, not as a pure quality leaderboard.

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Release volume is accelerating



TRACKS IN THE DATASET

440 → 730

About 440 tracks appear from 2020 versus **about 730** from 2025.

Decade filters move the dashboard from the long view to a specific era. A larger release pool shapes today's popularity landscape.

Dashboard evidence: release-year trend and decade filters

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What the analysis can and cannot say

- Spotify popularity is a 0–100 score, not a direct stream-count measure.
- Genre is inherited from the artist, and 39% of tracks have an unknown genre.
- Correlation does not prove causation.
- Next step: add streams, playlist reach, saves, and recency to test whether these patterns hold beyond the score.



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